

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Sculpture, Pottery and Iconography - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Sculpture, Pottery and Iconography	
REFRESHED TEACHING NAVIGATION — BASIC/CORE FIRST	
01	FOUNDATION — HOW TO READ SCULPTURE Evidence chain: Six-variable sculpture method Qualified use: Use the
02	FOUNDATION — LOST-WAX BRONZE AND HARAPPAN LABELS Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern interpretive
03	FOUNDATION — POTTERY AS CHRONOLOGICAL EVIDENCE NBPW is fine lustrous tableware associated especially with early
04	CORE — YAKSHA AND AUSPICIOUS TREE FIGURES Evidence chain: Yaksha, Yakshi and Shalabhanjika Qualified use: Use
05	CORE — GANDHARA'S LAYERED IDIOM Evidence chain: Gandhara school Qualified use: Prepare the direct
06	CORE — MATHURA'S INDIGENOUS BREADTH Evidence chain: Mathura school Qualified use: Contrast material,
07	CORE — AMARAVATI'S NARRATIVE DYNAMISM Technically, CORE — Amaravati's narrative dynamism is analysed by
08	CORE — ANICONISM AND THE ICONIC SHIFT Early Buddhist programmes marked the Buddha through symbols
09	CORE — GUPTA RESTRAINT AND DATING LIMITS The Samath school used cream-coloured sandstone and metal for
10	CORE — NATARAJA FROM AIHOLE TO CHOLA Evidence chain: Nataraja origin and peak - Nataraja attribute system
11	CORE — LION AND BULL ACROSS MEDIA Evidence chain: Lion and bull programme - Nandi as architecture
12	CORE — NANDI, YALI AND VYALA Evidence chain: Nandi as architecture - Yali and Vyala distinction
13	CORE SYNTHESIS — SCULPTURE AS SOCIAL EVIDENCE Evidence chain: Temple sculpture as social evidence Qualified use:
14	CORE SYNTHESIS — TERRACOTTA'S LONG MATERIAL ARC Terracotta moves from Harappan figurines and plough models to
15	CORE SYNTHESIS — VERIFIED PYQS AND FINAL ANSWER SPINE Evidence chain: Verified sculpture PYQ routes - Six-variable sculpture

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Sculpture, Pottery and Iconography - Solved Practice Workbook 6

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION 6

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Six-variable sculpture method?	6
Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under Six-variable sculpture method?	6
Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Six-variable sculpture method?	6
Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Six-variable sculpture method?	6
Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Cire-perdue technique?	7
Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under Cire-perdue technique?	7
Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Cire-perdue technique?	7
Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Cire-perdue technique?	7
Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Harappan label caution?	8
Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Harappan label caution?	8
Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Harappan label caution?	8
Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Harappan label caution?	8
Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Pottery sequence?	9
Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Pottery sequence?	9
Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Pottery sequence?	9
Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Pottery sequence?	9
Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Northern Black Polished Ware?	10
Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under Northern Black Polished Ware?	10
Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Northern Black Polished Ware?	10
Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Northern Black Polished Ware?	10
Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Yaksha, Yakshi and Shalabhanjika?	11
Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Yaksha, Yakshi and Shalabhanjika?	11
Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Yaksha, Yakshi and Shalabhanjika?	11
Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Yaksha, Yakshi and Shalabhanjika?	11
Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Gandhara school?	12
Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Gandhara school?	12
Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Gandhara school?	12

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Gandhara school?	12
Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Mathura school?	13
Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under Mathura school?	13
Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Mathura school?	13
Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Mathura school?	13
Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Amaravati school?	14
Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under Amaravati school?	14
Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Amaravati school?	14
Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Amaravati school?	14
Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Aniconic symbolism?	15
Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under Aniconic symbolism?	15
Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Aniconic symbolism?	15
Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Aniconic symbolism?	15
Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Parallel iconic shift?	16
Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Parallel iconic shift?	16
Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Parallel iconic shift?	16
Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Parallel iconic shift?	16
Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Gupta Sarnath idiom?	17
Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Gupta Sarnath idiom?	17
Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Gupta Sarnath idiom?	17
Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Gupta Sarnath idiom?	17
Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Nataraja origin and peak?	18
Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under Nataraja origin and peak?	18
Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Nataraja origin and peak?	18
Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Nataraja origin and peak?	18
Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Nataraja attribute system?	19
Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under Nataraja attribute system?	19
Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Nataraja attribute system?	19
Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Nataraja attribute system?	19
Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Lion and bull programme?	20
Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Lion and bull programme?	20
Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Lion and bull programme?	20

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Lion and bull programme?	20
Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Nandi as architecture?	21
Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Nandi as architecture?	21
Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Nandi as architecture?	21
Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Nandi as architecture?	21
Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Yali and Vyala distinction?	22
Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Yali and Vyala distinction?	22
Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Yali and Vyala distinction?	22
Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Yali and Vyala distinction?	22
Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Temple sculpture as social evidence?	23
Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Temple sculpture as social evidence?	23
Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Temple sculpture as social evidence?	23
Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Temple sculpture as social evidence?	23
Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Terracotta continuity?	24
Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Terracotta continuity?	24
Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Terracotta continuity?	24
Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Terracotta continuity?	24
Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Verified sculpture PYQ routes?	25
Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified sculpture PYQ routes?	26
Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified sculpture PYQ routes?	27
Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified sculpture PYQ routes?	28
PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE	28
VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT	29
OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS	29
PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2019 GS-I	30
PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2022 GS-I	31
PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2022 GS-I	31
ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS	32
ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS	33
ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS	33
ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS	35
ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS	36

Sculpture, Pottery and Iconography - Solved Practice Workbook

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Six-variable sculpture method?

A. Read sculpture through material, posture or gesture, iconographic attribute, patron, site context and cross-site comparison; this converts visual description into bounded historical analysis. B. In lost-wax casting a wax model is clay-coated, heated so the wax drains away, and filled with molten metal; the technique is evidenced from the Indus tradition and later enabled free-standing bronzes. C. Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern interpretive labels for Harappan objects, not identities read from the undeciphered script. D. The source spine runs from Neolithic hand-made coarse ware through Chalcolithic painted wares, Harappan Red Ware and Painted Grey Ware to Northern Black Polished Ware.

Answer: A. Explanation: Read sculpture through material, posture or gesture, iconographic attribute, patron, site context and cross-site comparison; this converts visual description into bounded historical analysis. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under Six-variable sculpture method?

A. The source spine runs from Neolithic hand-made coarse ware through Chalcolithic painted wares, Harappan Red Ware and Painted Grey Ware to Northern Black Polished Ware. B. Read sculpture through material, posture or gesture, iconographic attribute, patron, site context and cross-site comparison; this converts visual description into bounded historical analysis. C. NBPW is fine lustrous tableware associated especially with early historic urbanisation; it is not exclusively a Mauryan court product and is not the same as Black-and-Red Ware. D. Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern interpretive labels for Harappan objects, not identities read from the undeciphered script.

Answer: B. Explanation: Read sculpture through material, posture or gesture, iconographic attribute, patron, site context and cross-site comparison; this converts visual description into bounded historical analysis. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Six-variable sculpture method?

A. The source spine runs from Neolithic hand-made coarse ware through Chalcolithic painted wares, Harappan Red Ware and Painted Grey Ware to Northern Black Polished Ware. B. NBPW is fine lustrous tableware associated especially with early historic urbanisation; it is not exclusively a Mauryan court product and is not the same as Black-and-Red Ware. C. Read sculpture through material, posture or gesture, iconographic attribute, patron, site context and cross-site comparison; this converts visual description into bounded historical analysis. D. Yaksha and Yakshi figures connect water, fertility, trees and wilderness with multiple religions; the Shalabhanjika is a tree-holding yakshi used as an auspicious bracket figure.

Answer: C. Explanation: Read sculpture through material, posture or gesture, iconographic attribute, patron, site context and cross-site comparison; this converts visual description into bounded historical analysis. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Six-variable sculpture method?

A. Gandhara sculpture used bluish-grey sandstone and later stucco for a mainly Buddhist programme whose drapery, hair and body modelling show Hellenistic, Parthian and Central Asian layers. B. NBPW is fine lustrous tableware associated especially with early historic urbanisation; it is not exclusively a Mauryan court product and is not the same as Black-and-Red Ware. C. Yaksha and Yakshi figures connect water, fertility, trees and wilderness with multiple religions; the Shalabhanjika is a tree-holding yakshi used as an auspicious bracket figure. D. Read sculpture through material, posture or gesture, iconographic attribute, patron, site context and cross-site comparison; this converts visual description into bounded historical analysis.

Answer: D. Explanation: Read sculpture through material, posture or gesture, iconographic attribute, patron, site context and cross-site comparison; this converts visual description into bounded historical analysis. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Cire-perdue technique?

A. In lost-wax casting a wax model is clay-coated, heated so the wax drains away, and filled with molten metal; the technique is evidenced from the Indus tradition and later enabled free-standing bronzes. B. The source spine runs from Neolithic hand-made coarse ware through Chalcolithic painted wares, Harappan Red Ware and Painted Grey Ware to Northern Black Polished Ware. C. Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern interpretive labels for Harappan objects, not identities read from the undeciphered script. D. NBPW is fine lustrous tableware associated especially with early historic urbanisation; it is not exclusively a Mauryan court product and is not the same as Black-and-Red Ware.

Answer: A. Explanation: In lost-wax casting a wax model is clay-coated, heated so the wax drains away, and filled with molten metal; the technique is evidenced from the Indus tradition and later enabled free-standing bronzes. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under Cire-perdue technique?

A. Yaksha and Yakshi figures connect water, fertility, trees and wilderness with multiple religions; the Shalabhanjika is a tree-holding yakshi used as an auspicious bracket figure. B. In lost-wax casting a wax model is clay-coated, heated so the wax drains away, and filled with molten metal; the technique is evidenced from the Indus tradition and later enabled free-standing bronzes. C. NBPW is fine lustrous tableware associated especially with early historic urbanisation; it is not exclusively a Mauryan court product and is not the same as Black-and-Red Ware. D. The source spine runs from Neolithic hand-made coarse ware through Chalcolithic painted wares, Harappan Red Ware and Painted Grey Ware to Northern Black Polished Ware.

Answer: B. Explanation: In lost-wax casting a wax model is clay-coated, heated so the wax drains away, and filled with molten metal; the technique is evidenced from the Indus tradition and later enabled free-standing bronzes. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Cire-perdue technique?

A. NBPW is fine lustrous tableware associated especially with early historic urbanisation; it is not exclusively a Mauryan court product and is not the same as Black-and-Red Ware. B. Yaksha and Yakshi figures connect water, fertility, trees and wilderness with multiple religions; the Shalabhanjika is a tree-holding yakshi used as an auspicious bracket figure. C. In lost-wax casting a wax model is clay-coated, heated so the wax drains away, and filled with molten metal; the technique is evidenced from the Indus tradition and later enabled free-standing bronzes. D. Gandhara sculpture used bluish-grey sandstone and later stucco for a mainly Buddhist programme whose drapery, hair and body modelling show Hellenistic, Parthian and Central Asian layers.

Answer: C. Explanation: In lost-wax casting a wax model is clay-coated, heated so the wax drains away, and filled with molten metal; the technique is evidenced from the Indus tradition and later enabled free-standing bronzes. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Cire-perdue technique?

A. Yaksha and Yakshi figures connect water, fertility, trees and wilderness with multiple religions; the Shalabhanjika is a tree-holding yakshi used as an auspicious bracket figure. B. Gandhara sculpture used bluish-grey sandstone and later stucco for a mainly Buddhist programme whose drapery, hair and body modelling show Hellenistic, Parthian and Central Asian layers. C. Mathura developed in spotted red sandstone, served Buddhist, Hindu and Jain patrons, and used attributes or avayudhas and emphatic halos within an indigenous visual grammar. D. In lost-wax casting a wax model is clay-coated, heated so the wax drains away, and filled with molten metal; the technique is evidenced from the Indus tradition and later enabled free-standing bronzes.

Answer: D. Explanation: In lost-wax casting a wax model is clay-coated, heated so the wax drains away, and filled with molten metal; the technique is evidenced from the Indus tradition and later enabled free-standing bronzes. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Harappan label caution?

A. Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern interpretive labels for Harappan objects, not identities read from the undeciphered script. B. The source spine runs from Neolithic hand-made coarse ware through Chalcolithic painted wares, Harappan Red Ware and Painted Grey Ware to Northern Black Polished Ware. C. NBPW is fine lustrous tableware associated especially with early historic urbanisation; it is not exclusively a Mauryan court product and is not the same as Black-and-Red Ware. D. Yaksha and Yakshi figures connect water, fertility, trees and wilderness with multiple religions; the Shalabhanjika is a tree-holding yakshi used as an auspicious bracket figure.

Answer: A. Explanation: Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern interpretive labels for Harappan objects, not identities read from the undeciphered script. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Harappan label caution?

A. Yaksha and Yakshi figures connect water, fertility, trees and wilderness with multiple religions; the Shalabhanjika is a tree-holding yakshi used as an auspicious bracket figure. B. Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern interpretive labels for Harappan objects, not identities read from the undeciphered script. C. Gandhara sculpture used bluish-grey sandstone and later stucco for a mainly Buddhist programme whose drapery, hair and body modelling show Hellenistic, Parthian and Central Asian layers. D. NBPW is fine lustrous tableware associated especially with early historic urbanisation; it is not exclusively a Mauryan court product and is not the same as Black-and-Red Ware.

Answer: B. Explanation: Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern interpretive labels for Harappan objects, not identities read from the undeciphered script. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Harappan label caution?

A. Yaksha and Yakshi figures connect water, fertility, trees and wilderness with multiple religions; the Shalabhanjika is a tree-holding yakshi used as an auspicious bracket figure. B. Gandhara sculpture used bluish-grey sandstone and later stucco for a mainly Buddhist programme whose drapery, hair and body modelling show Hellenistic, Parthian and Central Asian layers. C. Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern interpretive labels for Harappan objects, not identities read from the undeciphered script. D. Mathura developed in spotted red sandstone, served Buddhist, Hindu and Jain patrons, and used attributes or avayudhas and emphatic halos within an indigenous visual grammar.

Answer: C. Explanation: Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern interpretive labels for Harappan objects, not identities read from the undeciphered script. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Harappan label caution?

A. Mathura developed in spotted red sandstone, served Buddhist, Hindu and Jain patrons, and used attributes or avayudhas and emphatic halos within an indigenous visual grammar. B. Gandhara sculpture used bluish-grey sandstone and later stucco for a mainly Buddhist programme whose drapery, hair and body modelling show Hellenistic, Parthian and Central Asian layers. C. Amaravati or Vengi sculpture used dynamic narrative relief, greenish-white limestone and extensive tribhanga within a mainly Buddhist Satavahana and later Ikshvaku setting. D. Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern interpretive labels for Harappan objects, not identities read from the undeciphered script.

Answer: D. Explanation: Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern interpretive labels for Harappan objects, not identities read from the undeciphered script. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Pottery sequence?

A. The source spine runs from Neolithic hand-made coarse ware through Chalcolithic painted wares, Harappan Red Ware and Painted Grey Ware to Northern Black Polished Ware. B. NBPW is fine lustrous tableware associated especially with early historic urbanisation; it is not exclusively a Mauryan court product and is not the same as Black-and-Red Ware. C. Gandhara sculpture used bluish-grey sandstone and later stucco for a mainly Buddhist programme whose drapery, hair and body modelling show Hellenistic, Parthian and Central Asian layers. D. Yaksha and Yakshi figures connect water, fertility, trees and wilderness with multiple religions; the Shalabhanjika is a tree-holding yakshi used as an auspicious bracket figure.

Answer: A. Explanation: The source spine runs from Neolithic hand-made coarse ware through Chalcolithic painted wares, Harappan Red Ware and Painted Grey Ware to Northern Black Polished Ware. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Pottery sequence?

A. Gandhara sculpture used bluish-grey sandstone and later stucco for a mainly Buddhist programme whose drapery, hair and body modelling show Hellenistic, Parthian and Central Asian layers. B. The source spine runs from Neolithic hand-made coarse ware through Chalcolithic painted wares, Harappan Red Ware and Painted Grey Ware to Northern Black Polished Ware. C. Yaksha and Yakshi figures connect water, fertility, trees and wilderness with multiple religions; the Shalabhanjika is a tree-holding yakshi used as an auspicious bracket figure. D. Mathura developed in spotted red sandstone, served Buddhist, Hindu and Jain patrons, and used attributes or avayudhas and emphatic halos within an indigenous visual grammar.

Answer: B. Explanation: The source spine runs from Neolithic hand-made coarse ware through Chalcolithic painted wares, Harappan Red Ware and Painted Grey Ware to Northern Black Polished Ware. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Pottery sequence?

A. Mathura developed in spotted red sandstone, served Buddhist, Hindu and Jain patrons, and used attributes or avayudhas and emphatic halos within an indigenous visual grammar. B. Gandhara sculpture used bluish-grey sandstone and later stucco for a mainly Buddhist programme whose drapery, hair and body modelling show Hellenistic, Parthian and Central Asian layers. C. The source spine runs from Neolithic hand-made coarse ware through Chalcolithic painted wares, Harappan Red Ware and Painted Grey Ware to Northern Black Polished Ware. D. Amaravati or Vengi sculpture used dynamic narrative relief, greenish-white limestone and extensive tribhanga within a mainly Buddhist Satavahana and later Ikshvaku setting.

Answer: C. Explanation: The source spine runs from Neolithic hand-made coarse ware through Chalcolithic painted wares, Harappan Red Ware and Painted Grey Ware to Northern Black Polished Ware. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Pottery sequence?

A. Mathura developed in spotted red sandstone, served Buddhist, Hindu and Jain patrons, and used attributes or avayudhas and emphatic halos within an indigenous visual grammar. B. Amaravati or Vengi sculpture used dynamic narrative relief, greenish-white limestone and extensive tribhanga within a mainly Buddhist Satavahana and later Ikshvaku setting. C. Early Buddhist programmes marked the Buddha through symbols such as the empty throne, Bodhi tree, wheel, footprints and stupa; an empty seat is a presence-marker, not a missing figure. D. The source spine runs from Neolithic hand-made coarse ware through Chalcolithic painted wares, Harappan Red Ware and Painted Grey Ware to Northern Black Polished Ware.

Answer: D. Explanation: The source spine runs from Neolithic hand-made coarse ware through Chalcolithic painted wares, Harappan Red Ware and Painted Grey Ware to Northern Black Polished Ware. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Northern Black Polished Ware?

A. NBPW is fine lustrous tableware associated especially with early historic urbanisation; it is not exclusively a Mauryan court product and is not the same as Black-and-Red Ware. B. Mathura developed in spotted red sandstone, served Buddhist, Hindu and Jain patrons, and used attributes or avayudhas and emphatic halos within an indigenous visual grammar. C. Yaksha and Yakshi figures connect water, fertility, trees and wilderness with multiple religions; the Shalabhanjika is a tree-holding yakshi used as an auspicious bracket figure. D. Gandhara sculpture used bluish-grey sandstone and later stucco for a mainly Buddhist programme whose drapery, hair and body modelling show Hellenistic, Parthian and Central Asian layers.

Answer: A. Explanation: NBPW is fine lustrous tableware associated especially with early historic urbanisation; it is not exclusively a Mauryan court product and is not the same as Black-and-Red Ware. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under Northern Black Polished Ware?

A. Mathura developed in spotted red sandstone, served Buddhist, Hindu and Jain patrons, and used attributes or avayudhas and emphatic halos within an indigenous visual grammar. B. NBPW is fine lustrous tableware associated especially with early historic urbanisation; it is not exclusively a Mauryan court product and is not the same as Black-and-Red Ware. C. Amaravati or Vengi sculpture used dynamic narrative relief, greenish-white limestone and extensive tribhanga within a mainly Buddhist Satavahana and later Ikshvaku setting. D. Gandhara sculpture used bluish-grey sandstone and later stucco for a mainly Buddhist programme whose drapery, hair and body modelling show Hellenistic, Parthian and Central Asian layers.

Answer: B. Explanation: NBPW is fine lustrous tableware associated especially with early historic urbanisation; it is not exclusively a Mauryan court product and is not the same as Black-and-Red Ware. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Northern Black Polished Ware?

A. Mathura developed in spotted red sandstone, served Buddhist, Hindu and Jain patrons, and used attributes or avayudhas and emphatic halos within an indigenous visual grammar. B. Amaravati or Vengi sculpture used dynamic narrative relief, greenish-white limestone and extensive tribhanga within a mainly Buddhist Satavahana and later Ikshvaku setting. C. NBPW is fine lustrous tableware associated especially with early historic urbanisation; it is not exclusively a Mauryan court product and is not the same as Black-and-Red Ware. D. Early Buddhist programmes marked the Buddha through symbols such as the empty throne, Bodhi tree, wheel, footprints and stupa; an empty seat is a presence-marker, not a missing figure.

Answer: C. Explanation: NBPW is fine lustrous tableware associated especially with early historic urbanisation; it is not exclusively a Mauryan court product and is not the same as Black-and-Red Ware. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Northern Black Polished Ware?

A. Amaravati or Vengi sculpture used dynamic narrative relief, greenish-white limestone and extensive tribhanga within a mainly Buddhist Satavahana and later Ikshvaku setting. B. Anthropomorphic Buddha images emerged in broadly overlapping early-CE contexts at Gandhara and Mathura, so neither school should be declared the uncontested sole origin. C. Early Buddhist programmes marked the Buddha through symbols such as the empty throne, Bodhi tree, wheel, footprints and stupa; an empty seat is a presence-marker, not a missing figure. D. NBPW is fine lustrous tableware associated especially with early historic urbanisation; it is not exclusively a Mauryan court product and is not the same as Black-and-Red Ware.

Answer: D. Explanation: NBPW is fine lustrous tableware associated especially with early historic urbanisation; it is not exclusively a Mauryan court product and is not the same as Black-and-Red Ware. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Yaksha, Yakshi and Shalabhanjika?

A. Yaksha and Yakshi figures connect water, fertility, trees and wilderness with multiple religions; the Shalabhanjika is a tree-holding yakshi used as an auspicious bracket figure. B. Amaravati or Vengi sculpture used dynamic narrative relief, greenish-white limestone and extensive tribhanga within a mainly Buddhist Satavahana and later Ikshvaku setting. C. Gandhara sculpture used bluish-grey sandstone and later stucco for a mainly Buddhist programme whose drapery, hair and body modelling show Hellenistic, Parthian and Central Asian layers. D. Mathura developed in spotted red sandstone, served Buddhist, Hindu and Jain patrons, and used attributes or avayudhas and emphatic halos within an indigenous visual grammar.

Answer: A. Explanation: Yaksha and Yakshi figures connect water, fertility, trees and wilderness with multiple religions; the Shalabhanjika is a tree-holding yakshi used as an auspicious bracket figure. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Yaksha, Yakshi and Shalabhanjika?

A. Early Buddhist programmes marked the Buddha through symbols such as the empty throne, Bodhi tree, wheel, footprints and stupa; an empty seat is a presence-marker, not a missing figure. B. Yaksha and Yakshi figures connect water, fertility, trees and wilderness with multiple religions; the Shalabhanjika is a tree-holding yakshi used as an auspicious bracket figure. C. Amaravati or Vengi sculpture used dynamic narrative relief, greenish-white limestone and extensive tribhanga within a mainly Buddhist Satavahana and later Ikshvaku setting. D. Mathura developed in spotted red sandstone, served Buddhist, Hindu and Jain patrons, and used attributes or avayudhas and emphatic halos within an indigenous visual grammar.

Answer: B. Explanation: Yaksha and Yakshi figures connect water, fertility, trees and wilderness with multiple religions; the Shalabhanjika is a tree-holding yakshi used as an auspicious bracket figure. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Yaksha, Yakshi and Shalabhanjika?

A. Anthropomorphic Buddha images emerged in broadly overlapping early-CE contexts at Gandhara and Mathura, so neither school should be declared the uncontested sole origin. B. Early Buddhist programmes marked the Buddha through symbols such as the empty throne, Bodhi tree, wheel, footprints and stupa; an empty seat is a presence-marker, not a missing figure. C. Yaksha and Yakshi figures connect water, fertility, trees and wilderness with multiple religions; the Shalabhanjika is a tree-holding yakshi used as an auspicious bracket figure. D. Amaravati or Vengi sculpture used dynamic narrative relief, greenish-white limestone and extensive tribhanga within a mainly Buddhist Satavahana and later Ikshvaku setting.

Answer: C. Explanation: Yaksha and Yakshi figures connect water, fertility, trees and wilderness with multiple religions; the Shalabhanjika is a tree-holding yakshi used as an auspicious bracket figure. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Yaksha, Yakshi and Shalabhanjika?

A. Early Buddhist programmes marked the Buddha through symbols such as the empty throne, Bodhi tree, wheel, footprints and stupa; an empty seat is a presence-marker, not a missing figure. B. Anthropomorphic Buddha images emerged in broadly overlapping early-CE contexts at Gandhara and Mathura, so neither school should be declared the uncontested sole origin. C. The Sarnath school used cream-coloured sandstone and metal for subtly modelled, thinly draped figures; the Sultanganj copper Buddha is safer described as late or post-Gupta. D. Yaksha and Yakshi figures connect water, fertility, trees and wilderness with multiple religions; the Shalabhanjika is a tree-holding yakshi used as an auspicious bracket figure.

Answer: D. Explanation: Yaksha and Yakshi figures connect water, fertility, trees and wilderness with multiple religions; the Shalabhanjika is a tree-holding yakshi used as an auspicious bracket figure. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Gandhara school?

A. Gandhara sculpture used bluish-grey sandstone and later stucco for a mainly Buddhist programme whose drapery, hair and body modelling show Hellenistic, Parthian and Central Asian layers. B. Amaravati or Vengi sculpture used dynamic narrative relief, greenish-white limestone and extensive tribhanga within a mainly Buddhist Satavahana and later Ikshvaku setting. C. Early Buddhist programmes marked the Buddha through symbols such as the empty throne, Bodhi tree, wheel, footprints and stupa; an empty seat is a presence-marker, not a missing figure. D. Mathura developed in spotted red sandstone, served Buddhist, Hindu and Jain patrons, and used attributes or avayudhas and emphatic halos within an indigenous visual grammar.

Answer: A. Explanation: Gandhara sculpture used bluish-grey sandstone and later stucco for a mainly Buddhist programme whose drapery, hair and body modelling show Hellenistic, Parthian and Central Asian layers. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Gandhara school?

A. Early Buddhist programmes marked the Buddha through symbols such as the empty throne, Bodhi tree, wheel, footprints and stupa; an empty seat is a presence-marker, not a missing figure. B. Gandhara sculpture used bluish-grey sandstone and later stucco for a mainly Buddhist programme whose drapery, hair and body modelling show Hellenistic, Parthian and Central Asian layers. C. Anthropomorphic Buddha images emerged in broadly overlapping early-CE contexts at Gandhara and Mathura, so neither school should be declared the uncontested sole origin. D. Amaravati or Vengi sculpture used dynamic narrative relief, greenish-white limestone and extensive tribhanga within a mainly Buddhist Satavahana and later Ikshvaku setting.

Answer: B. Explanation: Gandhara sculpture used bluish-grey sandstone and later stucco for a mainly Buddhist programme whose drapery, hair and body modelling show Hellenistic, Parthian and Central Asian layers. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Gandhara school?

A. Early Buddhist programmes marked the Buddha through symbols such as the empty throne, Bodhi tree, wheel, footprints and stupa; an empty seat is a presence-marker, not a missing figure. B. The Sarnath school used cream-coloured sandstone and metal for subtly modelled, thinly draped figures; the Sultanganj copper Buddha is safer described as late or post-Gupta. C. Gandhara sculpture used bluish-grey sandstone and later stucco for a mainly Buddhist programme whose drapery, hair and body modelling show Hellenistic, Parthian and Central Asian layers. D. Anthropomorphic Buddha images emerged in broadly overlapping early-CE contexts at Gandhara and Mathura, so neither school should be declared the uncontested sole origin.

Answer: C. Explanation: Gandhara sculpture used bluish-grey sandstone and later stucco for a mainly Buddhist programme whose drapery, hair and body modelling show Hellenistic, Parthian and Central Asian layers. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Gandhara school?

A. The Sarnath school used cream-coloured sandstone and metal for subtly modelled, thinly draped figures; the Sultanganj copper Buddha is safer described as late or post-Gupta. B. The earliest known Nataraja example in the owner is at Ravana Phadi, Aihole, under early Chalukya rule; Chola bronzes perfected and ritualised the form rather than originating it. C. Anthropomorphic Buddha images emerged in broadly overlapping early-CE contexts at Gandhara and Mathura, so neither school should be declared the uncontested sole origin. D. Gandhara sculpture used bluish-grey sandstone and later stucco for a mainly Buddhist programme whose drapery, hair and body modelling show Hellenistic, Parthian and Central Asian layers.

Answer: D. Explanation: Gandhara sculpture used bluish-grey sandstone and later stucco for a mainly Buddhist programme whose drapery, hair and body modelling show Hellenistic, Parthian and Central Asian layers. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Mathura school?

A. Mathura developed in spotted red sandstone, served Buddhist, Hindu and Jain patrons, and used attributes or avayudhas and emphatic halos within an indigenous visual grammar. B. Anthropomorphic Buddha images emerged in broadly overlapping early-CE contexts at Gandhara and Mathura, so neither school should be declared the uncontested sole origin. C. Early Buddhist programmes marked the Buddha through symbols such as the empty throne, Bodhi tree, wheel, footprints and stupa; an empty seat is a presence-marker, not a missing figure. D. Amaravati or Vengi sculpture used dynamic narrative relief, greenish-white limestone and extensive tribhanga within a mainly Buddhist Satavahana and later Ikshvaku setting.

Answer: A. Explanation: Mathura developed in spotted red sandstone, served Buddhist, Hindu and Jain patrons, and used attributes or avayudhas and emphatic halos within an indigenous visual grammar. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under Mathura school?

A. Early Buddhist programmes marked the Buddha through symbols such as the empty throne, Bodhi tree, wheel, footprints and stupa; an empty seat is a presence-marker, not a missing figure. B. Mathura developed in spotted red sandstone, served Buddhist, Hindu and Jain patrons, and used attributes or avayudhas and emphatic halos within an indigenous visual grammar. C. The Sarnath school used cream-coloured sandstone and metal for subtly modelled, thinly draped figures; the Sultanganj copper Buddha is safer described as late or post-Gupta. D. Anthropomorphic Buddha images emerged in broadly overlapping early-CE contexts at Gandhara and Mathura, so neither school should be declared the uncontested sole origin.

Answer: B. Explanation: Mathura developed in spotted red sandstone, served Buddhist, Hindu and Jain patrons, and used attributes or avayudhas and emphatic halos within an indigenous visual grammar. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Mathura school?

A. Anthropomorphic Buddha images emerged in broadly overlapping early-CE contexts at Gandhara and Mathura, so neither school should be declared the uncontested sole origin. B. The Sarnath school used cream-coloured sandstone and metal for subtly modelled, thinly draped figures; the Sultanganj copper Buddha is safer described as late or post-Gupta. C. Mathura developed in spotted red sandstone, served Buddhist, Hindu and Jain patrons, and used attributes or avayudhas and emphatic halos within an indigenous visual grammar. D. The earliest known Nataraja example in the owner is at Ravana Phadi, Aihole, under early Chalukya rule; Chola bronzes perfected and ritualised the form rather than originating it.

Answer: C. Explanation: Mathura developed in spotted red sandstone, served Buddhist, Hindu and Jain patrons, and used attributes or avayudhas and emphatic halos within an indigenous visual grammar. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Mathura school?

A. Damaru signifies creation, fire destruction, abhaya reassurance, the raised foot release, Apasmara ignorance and the surrounding aureole cyclical time; each attribute must be read in position. B. The Sarnath school used cream-coloured sandstone and metal for subtly modelled, thinly draped figures; the Sultanganj copper Buddha is safer described as late or post-Gupta. C. The earliest known Nataraja example in the owner is at Ravana Phadi, Aihole, under early Chalukya rule; Chola bronzes perfected and ritualised the form rather than originating it. D. Mathura developed in spotted red sandstone, served Buddhist, Hindu and Jain patrons, and used attributes or avayudhas and emphatic halos within an indigenous visual grammar.

Answer: D. Explanation: Mathura developed in spotted red sandstone, served Buddhist, Hindu and Jain patrons, and used attributes or avayudhas and emphatic halos within an indigenous visual grammar. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Amaravati school?

A. Amaravati or Vengi sculpture used dynamic narrative relief, greenish-white limestone and extensive tribhanga within a mainly Buddhist Satavahana and later Ikshvaku setting. B. The Sarnath school used cream-coloured sandstone and metal for subtly modelled, thinly draped figures; the Sultanganj copper Buddha is safer described as late or post-Gupta. C. Early Buddhist programmes marked the Buddha through symbols such as the empty throne, Bodhi tree, wheel, footprints and stupa; an empty seat is a presence-marker, not a missing figure. D. Anthropomorphic Buddha images emerged in broadly overlapping early-CE contexts at Gandhara and Mathura, so neither school should be declared the uncontested sole origin.

Answer: A. Explanation: Amaravati or Vengi sculpture used dynamic narrative relief, greenish-white limestone and extensive tribhanga within a mainly Buddhist Satavahana and later Ikshvaku setting. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under Amaravati school?

A. Anthropomorphic Buddha images emerged in broadly overlapping early-CE contexts at Gandhara and Mathura, so neither school should be declared the uncontested sole origin. B. Amaravati or Vengi sculpture used dynamic narrative relief, greenish-white limestone and extensive tribhanga within a mainly Buddhist Satavahana and later Ikshvaku setting. C. The earliest known Nataraja example in the owner is at Ravana Phadi, Aihole, under early Chalukya rule; Chola bronzes perfected and ritualised the form rather than originating it. D. The Sarnath school used cream-coloured sandstone and metal for subtly modelled, thinly draped figures; the Sultanganj copper Buddha is safer described as late or post-Gupta.

Answer: B. Explanation: Amaravati or Vengi sculpture used dynamic narrative relief, greenish-white limestone and extensive tribhanga within a mainly Buddhist Satavahana and later Ikshvaku setting. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Amaravati school?

A. The Sarnath school used cream-coloured sandstone and metal for subtly modelled, thinly draped figures; the Sultanganj copper Buddha is safer described as late or post-Gupta. B. The earliest known Nataraja example in the owner is at Ravana Phadi, Aihole, under early Chalukya rule; Chola bronzes perfected and ritualised the form rather than originating it. C. Amaravati or Vengi sculpture used dynamic narrative relief, greenish-white limestone and extensive tribhanga within a mainly Buddhist Satavahana and later Ikshvaku setting. D. Damaru signifies creation, fire destruction, abhaya reassurance, the raised foot release, Apasmara ignorance and the surrounding aureole cyclical time; each attribute must be read in position.

Answer: C. Explanation: Amaravati or Vengi sculpture used dynamic narrative relief, greenish-white limestone and extensive tribhanga within a mainly Buddhist Satavahana and later Ikshvaku setting. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Amaravati school?

A. Damaru signifies creation, fire destruction, abhaya reassurance, the raised foot release, Apasmara ignorance and the surrounding aureole cyclical time; each attribute must be read in position. B. The earliest known Nataraja example in the owner is at Ravana Phadi, Aihole, under early Chalukya rule; Chola bronzes perfected and ritualised the form rather than originating it. C. Rampurva preserves an inscribed Ashokan lion pillar and an uninscribed bull pillar, while the Sarnath abacus places lion and bull within a wider Buddhist and imperial symbol system. D. Amaravati or Vengi sculpture used dynamic narrative relief, greenish-white limestone and extensive tribhanga within a mainly Buddhist Satavahana and later Ikshvaku setting.

Answer: D. Explanation: Amaravati or Vengi sculpture used dynamic narrative relief, greenish-white limestone and extensive tribhanga within a mainly Buddhist Satavahana and later Ikshvaku setting. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Aniconic symbolism?

A. Early Buddhist programmes marked the Buddha through symbols such as the empty throne, Bodhi tree, wheel, footprints and stupa; an empty seat is a presence-marker, not a missing figure. B. Anthropomorphic Buddha images emerged in broadly overlapping early-CE contexts at Gandhara and Mathura, so neither school should be declared the uncontested sole origin. C. The Sarnath school used cream-coloured sandstone and metal for subtly modelled, thinly draped figures; the Sultanganj copper Buddha is safer described as late or post-Gupta. D. The earliest known Nataraja example in the owner is at Ravana Phadi, Aihole, under early Chalukya rule; Chola bronzes perfected and ritualised the form rather than originating it.

Answer: A. Explanation: Early Buddhist programmes marked the Buddha through symbols such as the empty throne, Bodhi tree, wheel, footprints and stupa; an empty seat is a presence-marker, not a missing figure. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under Aniconic symbolism?

A. The earliest known Nataraja example in the owner is at Ravana Phadi, Aihole, under early Chalukya rule; Chola bronzes perfected and ritualised the form rather than originating it. B. Early Buddhist programmes marked the Buddha through symbols such as the empty throne, Bodhi tree, wheel, footprints and stupa; an empty seat is a presence-marker, not a missing figure. C. The Sarnath school used cream-coloured sandstone and metal for subtly modelled, thinly draped figures; the Sultanganj copper Buddha is safer described as late or post-Gupta. D. Damaru signifies creation, fire destruction, abhaya reassurance, the raised foot release, Apasmara ignorance and the surrounding aureole cyclical time; each attribute must be read in position.

Answer: B. Explanation: Early Buddhist programmes marked the Buddha through symbols such as the empty throne, Bodhi tree, wheel, footprints and stupa; an empty seat is a presence-marker, not a missing figure. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Aniconic symbolism?

A. The earliest known Nataraja example in the owner is at Ravana Phadi, Aihole, under early Chalukya rule; Chola bronzes perfected and ritualised the form rather than originating it. B. Rampurva preserves an inscribed Ashokan lion pillar and an uninscribed bull pillar, while the Sarnath abacus places lion and bull within a wider Buddhist and imperial symbol system. C. Early Buddhist programmes marked the Buddha through symbols such as the empty throne, Bodhi tree, wheel, footprints and stupa; an empty seat is a presence-marker, not a missing figure. D. Damaru signifies creation, fire destruction, abhaya reassurance, the raised foot release, Apasmara ignorance and the surrounding aureole cyclical time; each attribute must be read in position.

Answer: C. Explanation: Early Buddhist programmes marked the Buddha through symbols such as the empty throne, Bodhi tree, wheel, footprints and stupa; an empty seat is a presence-marker, not a missing figure. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Aniconic symbolism?

A. Rampurva preserves an inscribed Ashokan lion pillar and an uninscribed bull pillar, while the Sarnath abacus places lion and bull within a wider Buddhist and imperial symbol system. B. At Shaiva temples the bull is not merely ornament: a Nandi mandapa or pavilion stands axially before the sanctum, as at Brihadishvara, Ellora Kailasa and Ramappa. C. Damaru signifies creation, fire destruction, abhaya reassurance, the raised foot release, Apasmara ignorance and the surrounding aureole cyclical time; each attribute must be read in position. D. Early Buddhist programmes marked the Buddha through symbols such as the empty throne, Bodhi tree, wheel, footprints and stupa; an empty seat is a presence-marker, not a missing figure.

Answer: D. Explanation: Early Buddhist programmes marked the Buddha through symbols such as the empty throne, Bodhi tree, wheel, footprints and stupa; an empty seat is a presence-marker, not a missing figure. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Parallel iconic shift?

A. Anthropomorphic Buddha images emerged in broadly overlapping early-CE contexts at Gandhara and Mathura, so neither school should be declared the uncontested sole origin. B. The earliest known Nataraja example in the owner is at Ravana Phadi, Aihole, under early Chalukya rule; Chola bronzes perfected and ritualised the form rather than originating it. C. The Sarnath school used cream-coloured sandstone and metal for subtly modelled, thinly draped figures; the Sultanganj copper Buddha is safer described as late or post-Gupta. D. Damaru signifies creation, fire destruction, abhaya reassurance, the raised foot release, Apasmara ignorance and the surrounding aureole cyclical time; each attribute must be read in position.

Answer: A. Explanation: Anthropomorphic Buddha images emerged in broadly overlapping early-CE contexts at Gandhara and Mathura, so neither school should be declared the uncontested sole origin. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Parallel iconic shift?

A. Damaru signifies creation, fire destruction, abhaya reassurance, the raised foot release, Apasmara ignorance and the surrounding aureole cyclical time; each attribute must be read in position. B. Anthropomorphic Buddha images emerged in broadly overlapping early-CE contexts at Gandhara and Mathura, so neither school should be declared the uncontested sole origin. C. The earliest known Nataraja example in the owner is at Ravana Phadi, Aihole, under early Chalukya rule; Chola bronzes perfected and ritualised the form rather than originating it. D. Rampurva preserves an inscribed Ashokan lion pillar and an uninscribed bull pillar, while the Sarnath abacus places lion and bull within a wider Buddhist and imperial symbol system.

Answer: B. Explanation: Anthropomorphic Buddha images emerged in broadly overlapping early-CE contexts at Gandhara and Mathura, so neither school should be declared the uncontested sole origin. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Parallel iconic shift?

A. Rampurva preserves an inscribed Ashokan lion pillar and an uninscribed bull pillar, while the Sarnath abacus places lion and bull within a wider Buddhist and imperial symbol system. B. Damaru signifies creation, fire destruction, abhaya reassurance, the raised foot release, Apasmara ignorance and the surrounding aureole cyclical time; each attribute must be read in position. C. Anthropomorphic Buddha images emerged in broadly overlapping early-CE contexts at Gandhara and Mathura, so neither school should be declared the uncontested sole origin. D. At Shaiva temples the bull is not merely ornament: a Nandi mandapa or pavilion stands axially before the sanctum, as at Brihadishvara, Ellora Kailasa and Ramappa.

Answer: C. Explanation: Anthropomorphic Buddha images emerged in broadly overlapping early-CE contexts at Gandhara and Mathura, so neither school should be declared the uncontested sole origin. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Parallel iconic shift?

A. Yali is a composite lion-based guardian associated especially with Vijayanagara pillars and Nayaka identity, while Khajuraho Vyalas are hybrid imaginary animals with lions' bodies. B. Rampurva preserves an inscribed Ashokan lion pillar and an uninscribed bull pillar, while the Sarnath abacus places lion and bull within a wider Buddhist and imperial symbol system. C. At Shaiva temples the bull is not merely ornament: a Nandi mandapa or pavilion stands axially before the sanctum, as at Brihadishvara, Ellora Kailasa and Ramappa. D. Anthropomorphic Buddha images emerged in broadly overlapping early-CE contexts at Gandhara and Mathura, so neither school should be declared the uncontested sole origin.

Answer: D. Explanation: Anthropomorphic Buddha images emerged in broadly overlapping early-CE contexts at Gandhara and Mathura, so neither school should be declared the uncontested sole origin. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Gupta Sarnath idiom?

A. The Sarnath school used cream-coloured sandstone and metal for subtly modelled, thinly draped figures; the Sultanganj copper Buddha is safer described as late or post-Gupta. B. Rampurva preserves an inscribed Ashokan lion pillar and an uninscribed bull pillar, while the Sarnath abacus places lion and bull within a wider Buddhist and imperial symbol system. C. Damaru signifies creation, fire destruction, abhaya reassurance, the raised foot release, Apasmara ignorance and the surrounding aureole cyclical time; each attribute must be read in position. D. The earliest known Nataraja example in the owner is at Ravana Phadi, Aihole, under early Chalukya rule; Chola bronzes perfected and ritualised the form rather than originating it.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Sarnath school used cream-coloured sandstone and metal for subtly modelled, thinly draped figures; the Sultanganj copper Buddha is safer described as late or post-Gupta. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Gupta Sarnath idiom?

A. Damaru signifies creation, fire destruction, abhaya reassurance, the raised foot release, Apasmara ignorance and the surrounding aureole cyclical time; each attribute must be read in position. B. The Sarnath school used cream-coloured sandstone and metal for subtly modelled, thinly draped figures; the Sultanganj copper Buddha is safer described as late or post-Gupta. C. Rampurva preserves an inscribed Ashokan lion pillar and an uninscribed bull pillar, while the Sarnath abacus places lion and bull within a wider Buddhist and imperial symbol system. D. At Shaiva temples the bull is not merely ornament: a Nandi mandapa or pavilion stands axially before the sanctum, as at Brihadishvara, Ellora Kailasa and Ramappa.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Sarnath school used cream-coloured sandstone and metal for subtly modelled, thinly draped figures; the Sultanganj copper Buddha is safer described as late or post-Gupta. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Gupta Sarnath idiom?

A. At Shaiva temples the bull is not merely ornament: a Nandi mandapa or pavilion stands axially before the sanctum, as at Brihadishvara, Ellora Kailasa and Ramappa. B. Rampurva preserves an inscribed Ashokan lion pillar and an uninscribed bull pillar, while the Sarnath abacus places lion and bull within a wider Buddhist and imperial symbol system. C. The Sarnath school used cream-coloured sandstone and metal for subtly modelled, thinly draped figures; the Sultanganj copper Buddha is safer described as late or post-Gupta. D. Yali is a composite lion-based guardian associated especially with Vijayanagara pillars and Nayaka identity, while Khajuraho Vyalas are hybrid imaginary animals with lions' bodies.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Sarnath school used cream-coloured sandstone and metal for subtly modelled, thinly draped figures; the Sultanganj copper Buddha is safer described as late or post-Gupta. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Gupta Sarnath idiom?

A. At Shaiva temples the bull is not merely ornament: a Nandi mandapa or pavilion stands axially before the sanctum, as at Brihadishvara, Ellora Kailasa and Ramappa. B. Dancers, musicians, teachers, couples and ritual scenes show what patrons selected for visibility; carvings are commissioned representations, not statistical photographs of medieval society. C. Yali is a composite lion-based guardian associated especially with Vijayanagara pillars and Nayaka identity, while Khajuraho Vyalas are hybrid imaginary animals with lions' bodies. D. The Sarnath school used cream-coloured sandstone and metal for subtly modelled, thinly draped figures; the Sultanganj copper Buddha is safer described as late or post-Gupta.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Sarnath school used cream-coloured sandstone and metal for subtly modelled, thinly draped figures; the Sultanganj copper Buddha is safer described as late or post-Gupta. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Nataraja origin and peak?

A. The earliest known Nataraja example in the owner is at Ravana Phadi, Aihole, under early Chalukya rule; Chola bronzes perfected and ritualised the form rather than originating it. B. At Shaiva temples the bull is not merely ornament: a Nandi mandapa or pavilion stands axially before the sanctum, as at Brihadishvara, Ellora Kailasa and Ramappa. C. Rampurva preserves an inscribed Ashokan lion pillar and an uninscribed bull pillar, while the Sarnath abacus places lion and bull within a wider Buddhist and imperial symbol system. D. Damaru signifies creation, fire destruction, abhaya reassurance, the raised foot release, Apasmara ignorance and the surrounding aureole cyclical time; each attribute must be read in position.

Answer: A. Explanation: The earliest known Nataraja example in the owner is at Ravana Phadi, Aihole, under early Chalukya rule; Chola bronzes perfected and ritualised the form rather than originating it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under Nataraja origin and peak?

A. Rampurva preserves an inscribed Ashokan lion pillar and an uninscribed bull pillar, while the Sarnath abacus places lion and bull within a wider Buddhist and imperial symbol system. B. The earliest known Nataraja example in the owner is at Ravana Phadi, Aihole, under early Chalukya rule; Chola bronzes perfected and ritualised the form rather than originating it. C. At Shaiva temples the bull is not merely ornament: a Nandi mandapa or pavilion stands axially before the sanctum, as at Brihadishvara, Ellora Kailasa and Ramappa. D. Yali is a composite lion-based guardian associated especially with Vijayanagara pillars and Nayaka identity, while Khajuraho Vyalas are hybrid imaginary animals with lions' bodies.

Answer: B. Explanation: The earliest known Nataraja example in the owner is at Ravana Phadi, Aihole, under early Chalukya rule; Chola bronzes perfected and ritualised the form rather than originating it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Nataraja origin and peak?

A. Dancers, musicians, teachers, couples and ritual scenes show what patrons selected for visibility; carvings are commissioned representations, not statistical photographs of medieval society. B. Yali is a composite lion-based guardian associated especially with Vijayanagara pillars and Nayaka identity, while Khajuraho Vyalas are hybrid imaginary animals with lions' bodies. C. The earliest known Nataraja example in the owner is at Ravana Phadi, Aihole, under early Chalukya rule; Chola bronzes perfected and ritualised the form rather than originating it. D. At Shaiva temples the bull is not merely ornament: a Nandi mandapa or pavilion stands axially before the sanctum, as at Brihadishvara, Ellora Kailasa and Ramappa.

Answer: C. Explanation: The earliest known Nataraja example in the owner is at Ravana Phadi, Aihole, under early Chalukya rule; Chola bronzes perfected and ritualised the form rather than originating it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Nataraja origin and peak?

A. Terracotta moves from Harappan figurines and plough models to Chandraketurgh craft, Gupta plaques and Bengal architectural relief, linking domestic objects, urban workshops and façades. B. Dancers, musicians, teachers, couples and ritual scenes show what patrons selected for visibility; carvings are commissioned representations, not statistical photographs of medieval society. C. Yali is a composite lion-based guardian associated especially with Vijayanagara pillars and Nayaka identity, while Khajuraho Vyalas are hybrid imaginary animals with lions' bodies. D. The earliest known Nataraja example in the owner is at Ravana Phadi, Aihole, under early Chalukya rule; Chola bronzes perfected and ritualised the form rather than originating it.

Answer: D. Explanation: The earliest known Nataraja example in the owner is at Ravana Phadi, Aihole, under early Chalukya rule; Chola bronzes perfected and ritualised the form rather than originating it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Nataraja attribute system?

A. Damaru signifies creation, fire destruction, abhaya reassurance, the raised foot release, Apasmara ignorance and the surrounding aureole cyclical time; each attribute must be read in position. B. Rampurva preserves an inscribed Ashokan lion pillar and an uninscribed bull pillar, while the Sarnath abacus places lion and bull within a wider Buddhist and imperial symbol system. C. Yali is a composite lion-based guardian associated especially with Vijayanagara pillars and Nayaka identity, while Khajuraho Vyalas are hybrid imaginary animals with lions' bodies. D. At Shaiva temples the bull is not merely ornament: a Nandi mandapa or pavilion stands axially before the sanctum, as at Brihadishvara, Ellora Kailasa and Ramappa.

Answer: A. Explanation: Damaru signifies creation, fire destruction, abhaya reassurance, the raised foot release, Apasmara ignorance and the surrounding aureole cyclical time; each attribute must be read in position. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under Nataraja attribute system?

A. Yali is a composite lion-based guardian associated especially with Vijayanagara pillars and Nayaka identity, while Khajuraho Vyalas are hybrid imaginary animals with lions' bodies. B. Damaru signifies creation, fire destruction, abhaya reassurance, the raised foot release, Apasmara ignorance and the surrounding aureole cyclical time; each attribute must be read in position. C. At Shaiva temples the bull is not merely ornament: a Nandi mandapa or pavilion stands axially before the sanctum, as at Brihadishvara, Ellora Kailasa and Ramappa. D. Dancers, musicians, teachers, couples and ritual scenes show what patrons selected for visibility; carvings are commissioned representations, not statistical photographs of medieval society.

Answer: B. Explanation: Damaru signifies creation, fire destruction, abhaya reassurance, the raised foot release, Apasmara ignorance and the surrounding aureole cyclical time; each attribute must be read in position. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Nataraja attribute system?

A. Yali is a composite lion-based guardian associated especially with Vijayanagara pillars and Nayaka identity, while Khajuraho Vyalas are hybrid imaginary animals with lions' bodies. B. Terracotta moves from Harappan figurines and plough models to Chandraketugarh craft, Gupta plaques and Bengal architectural relief, linking domestic objects, urban workshops and façades. C. Damaru signifies creation, fire destruction, abhaya reassurance, the raised foot release, Apasmara ignorance and the surrounding aureole cyclical time; each attribute must be read in position. D. Dancers, musicians, teachers, couples and ritual scenes show what patrons selected for visibility; carvings are commissioned representations, not statistical photographs of medieval society.

Answer: C. Explanation: Damaru signifies creation, fire destruction, abhaya reassurance, the raised foot release, Apasmara ignorance and the surrounding aureole cyclical time; each attribute must be read in position. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Nataraja attribute system?

A. Terracotta moves from Harappan figurines and plough models to Chandraketugarh craft, Gupta plaques and Bengal architectural relief, linking domestic objects, urban workshops and façades. B. The routed direct Mains cluster comprises 2019 Gandhara external elements and the 2022 demands on medieval temple sculpture as social evidence and lion-bull significance. C. Dancers, musicians, teachers, couples and ritual scenes show what patrons selected for visibility; carvings are commissioned representations, not statistical photographs of medieval society. D. Damaru signifies creation, fire destruction, abhaya reassurance, the raised foot release, Apasmara ignorance and the surrounding aureole cyclical time; each attribute must be read in position.

Answer: D. Explanation: Damaru signifies creation, fire destruction, abhaya reassurance, the raised foot release, Apasmara ignorance and the surrounding aureole cyclical time; each attribute must be read in position. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Lion and bull programme?

A. Rampurva preserves an inscribed Ashokan lion pillar and an uninscribed bull pillar, while the Sarnath abacus places lion and bull within a wider Buddhist and imperial symbol system. B. Dancers, musicians, teachers, couples and ritual scenes show what patrons selected for visibility; carvings are commissioned representations, not statistical photographs of medieval society. C. Yali is a composite lion-based guardian associated especially with Vijayanagara pillars and Nayaka identity, while Khajuraho Vyalas are hybrid imaginary animals with lions' bodies. D. At Shaiva temples the bull is not merely ornament: a Nandi mandapa or pavilion stands axially before the sanctum, as at Brihadishvara, Ellora Kailasa and Ramappa.

Answer: A. Explanation: Rampurva preserves an inscribed Ashokan lion pillar and an uninscribed bull pillar, while the Sarnath abacus places lion and bull within a wider Buddhist and imperial symbol system. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Lion and bull programme?

A. Yali is a composite lion-based guardian associated especially with Vijayanagara pillars and Nayaka identity, while Khajuraho Vyalas are hybrid imaginary animals with lions' bodies. B. Rampurva preserves an inscribed Ashokan lion pillar and an uninscribed bull pillar, while the Sarnath abacus places lion and bull within a wider Buddhist and imperial symbol system. C. Terracotta moves from Harappan figurines and plough models to Chandraketugarh craft, Gupta plaques and Bengal architectural relief, linking domestic objects, urban workshops and façades. D. Dancers, musicians, teachers, couples and ritual scenes show what patrons selected for visibility; carvings are commissioned representations, not statistical photographs of medieval society.

Answer: B. Explanation: Rampurva preserves an inscribed Ashokan lion pillar and an uninscribed bull pillar, while the Sarnath abacus places lion and bull within a wider Buddhist and imperial symbol system. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Lion and bull programme?

A. Terracotta moves from Harappan figurines and plough models to Chandraketugarh craft, Gupta plaques and Bengal architectural relief, linking domestic objects, urban workshops and façades. B. The routed direct Mains cluster comprises 2019 Gandhara external elements and the 2022 demands on medieval temple sculpture as social evidence and lion-bull significance. C. Rampurva preserves an inscribed Ashokan lion pillar and an uninscribed bull pillar, while the Sarnath abacus places lion and bull within a wider Buddhist and imperial symbol system. D. Dancers, musicians, teachers, couples and ritual scenes show what patrons selected for visibility; carvings are commissioned representations, not statistical photographs of medieval society.

Answer: C. Explanation: Rampurva preserves an inscribed Ashokan lion pillar and an uninscribed bull pillar, while the Sarnath abacus places lion and bull within a wider Buddhist and imperial symbol system. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Lion and bull programme?

A. Terracotta moves from Harappan figurines and plough models to Chandraketugarh craft, Gupta plaques and Bengal architectural relief, linking domestic objects, urban workshops and façades. B. Read sculpture through material, posture or gesture, iconographic attribute, patron, site context and cross-site comparison; this converts visual description into bounded historical analysis. C. The routed direct Mains cluster comprises 2019 Gandhara external elements and the 2022 demands on medieval temple sculpture as social evidence and lion-bull significance. D. Rampurva preserves an inscribed Ashokan lion pillar and an uninscribed bull pillar, while the Sarnath abacus places lion and bull within a wider Buddhist and imperial symbol system.

Answer: D. Explanation: Rampurva preserves an inscribed Ashokan lion pillar and an uninscribed bull pillar, while the Sarnath abacus places lion and bull within a wider Buddhist and imperial symbol system. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Nandi as architecture?

A. At Shaiva temples the bull is not merely ornament: a Nandi mandapa or pavilion stands axially before the sanctum, as at Brihadishvara, Ellora Kailasa and Ramappa. B. Terracotta moves from Harappan figurines and plough models to Chandraketugarh craft, Gupta plaques and Bengal architectural relief, linking domestic objects, urban workshops and façades. C. Yali is a composite lion-based guardian associated especially with Vijayanagara pillars and Nayaka identity, while Khajuraho Vyālas are hybrid imaginary animals with lions' bodies. D. Dancers, musicians, teachers, couples and ritual scenes show what patrons selected for visibility; carvings are commissioned representations, not statistical photographs of medieval society.

Answer: A. Explanation: At Shaiva temples the bull is not merely ornament: a Nandi mandapa or pavilion stands axially before the sanctum, as at Brihadishvara, Ellora Kailasa and Ramappa. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Nandi as architecture?

A. Dancers, musicians, teachers, couples and ritual scenes show what patrons selected for visibility; carvings are commissioned representations, not statistical photographs of medieval society. B. At Shaiva temples the bull is not merely ornament: a Nandi mandapa or pavilion stands axially before the sanctum, as at Brihadishvara, Ellora Kailasa and Ramappa. C. The routed direct Mains cluster comprises 2019 Gandhara external elements and the 2022 demands on medieval temple sculpture as social evidence and lion-bull significance. D. Terracotta moves from Harappan figurines and plough models to Chandraketugarh craft, Gupta plaques and Bengal architectural relief, linking domestic objects, urban workshops and façades.

Answer: B. Explanation: At Shaiva temples the bull is not merely ornament: a Nandi mandapa or pavilion stands axially before the sanctum, as at Brihadishvara, Ellora Kailasa and Ramappa. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Nandi as architecture?

A. The routed direct Mains cluster comprises 2019 Gandhara external elements and the 2022 demands on medieval temple sculpture as social evidence and lion-bull significance. B. Terracotta moves from Harappan figurines and plough models to Chandraketugarh craft, Gupta plaques and Bengal architectural relief, linking domestic objects, urban workshops and façades. C. At Shaiva temples the bull is not merely ornament: a Nandi mandapa or pavilion stands axially before the sanctum, as at Brihadishvara, Ellora Kailasa and Ramappa. D. Read sculpture through material, posture or gesture, iconographic attribute, patron, site context and cross-site comparison; this converts visual description into bounded historical analysis.

Answer: C. Explanation: At Shaiva temples the bull is not merely ornament: a Nandi mandapa or pavilion stands axially before the sanctum, as at Brihadishvara, Ellora Kailasa and Ramappa. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Nandi as architecture?

A. The routed direct Mains cluster comprises 2019 Gandhara external elements and the 2022 demands on medieval temple sculpture as social evidence and lion-bull significance. B. Read sculpture through material, posture or gesture, iconographic attribute, patron, site context and cross-site comparison; this converts visual description into bounded historical analysis. C. In lost-wax casting a wax model is clay-coated, heated so the wax drains away, and filled with molten metal; the technique is evidenced from the Indus tradition and later enabled free-standing bronzes. D. At Shaiva temples the bull is not merely ornament: a Nandi mandapa or pavilion stands axially before the sanctum, as at Brihadishvara, Ellora Kailasa and Ramappa.

Answer: D. Explanation: At Shaiva temples the bull is not merely ornament: a Nandi mandapa or pavilion stands axially before the sanctum, as at Brihadishvara, Ellora Kailasa and Ramappa. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Yali and Vyala distinction?

A. Yali is a composite lion-based guardian associated especially with Vijayanagara pillars and Nayaka identity, while Khajuraho Vyalas are hybrid imaginary animals with lions' bodies. B. Dancers, musicians, teachers, couples and ritual scenes show what patrons selected for visibility; carvings are commissioned representations, not statistical photographs of medieval society. C. The routed direct Mains cluster comprises 2019 Gandhara external elements and the 2022 demands on medieval temple sculpture as social evidence and lion-bull significance. D. Terracotta moves from Harappan figurines and plough models to Chandraketugarh craft, Gupta plaques and Bengal architectural relief, linking domestic objects, urban workshops and façades.

Answer: A. Explanation: Yali is a composite lion-based guardian associated especially with Vijayanagara pillars and Nayaka identity, while Khajuraho Vyalas are hybrid imaginary animals with lions' bodies. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Yali and Vyala distinction?

A. Terracotta moves from Harappan figurines and plough models to Chandraketugarh craft, Gupta plaques and Bengal architectural relief, linking domestic objects, urban workshops and façades. B. Yali is a composite lion-based guardian associated especially with Vijayanagara pillars and Nayaka identity, while Khajuraho Vyalas are hybrid imaginary animals with lions' bodies. C. The routed direct Mains cluster comprises 2019 Gandhara external elements and the 2022 demands on medieval temple sculpture as social evidence and lion-bull significance. D. Read sculpture through material, posture or gesture, iconographic attribute, patron, site context and cross-site comparison; this converts visual description into bounded historical analysis.

Answer: B. Explanation: Yali is a composite lion-based guardian associated especially with Vijayanagara pillars and Nayaka identity, while Khajuraho Vyalas are hybrid imaginary animals with lions' bodies. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Yali and Vyala distinction?

A. The routed direct Mains cluster comprises 2019 Gandhara external elements and the 2022 demands on medieval temple sculpture as social evidence and lion-bull significance. B. In lost-wax casting a wax model is clay-coated, heated so the wax drains away, and filled with molten metal; the technique is evidenced from the Indus tradition and later enabled free-standing bronzes. C. Yali is a composite lion-based guardian associated especially with Vijayanagara pillars and Nayaka identity, while Khajuraho Vyalas are hybrid imaginary animals with lions' bodies. D. Read sculpture through material, posture or gesture, iconographic attribute, patron, site context and cross-site comparison; this converts visual description into bounded historical analysis.

Answer: C. Explanation: Yali is a composite lion-based guardian associated especially with Vijayanagara pillars and Nayaka identity, while Khajuraho Vyalas are hybrid imaginary animals with lions' bodies. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Yali and Vyala distinction?

A. In lost-wax casting a wax model is clay-coated, heated so the wax drains away, and filled with molten metal; the technique is evidenced from the Indus tradition and later enabled free-standing bronzes. B. Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern interpretive labels for Harappan objects, not identities read from the undeciphered script. C. Read sculpture through material, posture or gesture, iconographic attribute, patron, site context and cross-site comparison; this converts visual description into bounded historical analysis. D. Yali is a composite lion-based guardian associated especially with Vijayanagara pillars and Nayaka identity, while Khajuraho Vyalas are hybrid imaginary animals with lions' bodies.

Answer: D. Explanation: Yali is a composite lion-based guardian associated especially with Vijayanagara pillars and Nayaka identity, while Khajuraho Vyalas are hybrid imaginary animals with lions' bodies. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Temple sculpture as social evidence?

A. Dancers, musicians, teachers, couples and ritual scenes show what patrons selected for visibility; carvings are commissioned representations, not statistical photographs of medieval society. B. Read sculpture through material, posture or gesture, iconographic attribute, patron, site context and cross-site comparison; this converts visual description into bounded historical analysis. C. The routed direct Mains cluster comprises 2019 Gandhara external elements and the 2022 demands on medieval temple sculpture as social evidence and lion-bull significance. D. Terracotta moves from Harappan figurines and plough models to Chandraketurgarh craft, Gupta plaques and Bengal architectural relief, linking domestic objects, urban workshops and façades.

Answer: A. Explanation: Dancers, musicians, teachers, couples and ritual scenes show what patrons selected for visibility; carvings are commissioned representations, not statistical photographs of medieval society. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Temple sculpture as social evidence?

A. The routed direct Mains cluster comprises 2019 Gandhara external elements and the 2022 demands on medieval temple sculpture as social evidence and lion-bull significance. B. Dancers, musicians, teachers, couples and ritual scenes show what patrons selected for visibility; carvings are commissioned representations, not statistical photographs of medieval society. C. Read sculpture through material, posture or gesture, iconographic attribute, patron, site context and cross-site comparison; this converts visual description into bounded historical analysis. D. In lost-wax casting a wax model is clay-coated, heated so the wax drains away, and filled with molten metal; the technique is evidenced from the Indus tradition and later enabled free-standing bronzes.

Answer: B. Explanation: Dancers, musicians, teachers, couples and ritual scenes show what patrons selected for visibility; carvings are commissioned representations, not statistical photographs of medieval society. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Temple sculpture as social evidence?

A. In lost-wax casting a wax model is clay-coated, heated so the wax drains away, and filled with molten metal; the technique is evidenced from the Indus tradition and later enabled free-standing bronzes. B. Read sculpture through material, posture or gesture, iconographic attribute, patron, site context and cross-site comparison; this converts visual description into bounded historical analysis. C. Dancers, musicians, teachers, couples and ritual scenes show what patrons selected for visibility; carvings are commissioned representations, not statistical photographs of medieval society. D. Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern interpretive labels for Harappan objects, not identities read from the undeciphered script.

Answer: C. Explanation: Dancers, musicians, teachers, couples and ritual scenes show what patrons selected for visibility; carvings are commissioned representations, not statistical photographs of medieval society. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Temple sculpture as social evidence?

A. In lost-wax casting a wax model is clay-coated, heated so the wax drains away, and filled with molten metal; the technique is evidenced from the Indus tradition and later enabled free-standing bronzes. B. The source spine runs from Neolithic hand-made coarse ware through Chalcolithic painted wares, Harappan Red Ware and Painted Grey Ware to Northern Black Polished Ware. C. Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern interpretive labels for Harappan objects, not identities read from the undeciphered script. D. Dancers, musicians, teachers, couples and ritual scenes show what patrons selected for visibility; carvings are commissioned representations, not statistical photographs of medieval society.

Answer: D. Explanation: Dancers, musicians, teachers, couples and ritual scenes show what patrons selected for visibility; carvings are commissioned representations, not statistical photographs of medieval society. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Terracotta continuity?

A. Terracotta moves from Harappan figurines and plough models to Chandraketugarh craft, Gupta plaques and Bengal architectural relief, linking domestic objects, urban workshops and façades. B. Read sculpture through material, posture or gesture, iconographic attribute, patron, site context and cross-site comparison; this converts visual description into bounded historical analysis. C. The routed direct Mains cluster comprises 2019 Gandhara external elements and the 2022 demands on medieval temple sculpture as social evidence and lion-bull significance. D. In lost-wax casting a wax model is clay-coated, heated so the wax drains away, and filled with molten metal; the technique is evidenced from the Indus tradition and later enabled free-standing bronzes.

Answer: A. Explanation: Terracotta moves from Harappan figurines and plough models to Chandraketugarh craft, Gupta plaques and Bengal architectural relief, linking domestic objects, urban workshops and façades. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Terracotta continuity?

A. Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern interpretive labels for Harappan objects, not identities read from the undeciphered script. B. Terracotta moves from Harappan figurines and plough models to Chandraketugarh craft, Gupta plaques and Bengal architectural relief, linking domestic objects, urban workshops and façades. C. Read sculpture through material, posture or gesture, iconographic attribute, patron, site context and cross-site comparison; this converts visual description into bounded historical analysis. D. In lost-wax casting a wax model is clay-coated, heated so the wax drains away, and filled with molten metal; the technique is evidenced from the Indus tradition and later enabled free-standing bronzes.

Answer: B. Explanation: Terracotta moves from Harappan figurines and plough models to Chandraketugarh craft, Gupta plaques and Bengal architectural relief, linking domestic objects, urban workshops and façades. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Terracotta continuity?

A. The source spine runs from Neolithic hand-made coarse ware through Chalcolithic painted wares, Harappan Red Ware and Painted Grey Ware to Northern Black Polished Ware. B. Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern interpretive labels for Harappan objects, not identities read from the undeciphered script. C. Terracotta moves from Harappan figurines and plough models to Chandraketugarh craft, Gupta plaques and Bengal architectural relief, linking domestic objects, urban workshops and façades. D. In lost-wax casting a wax model is clay-coated, heated so the wax drains away, and filled with molten metal; the technique is evidenced from the Indus tradition and later enabled free-standing bronzes.

Answer: C. Explanation: Terracotta moves from Harappan figurines and plough models to Chandraketugarh craft, Gupta plaques and Bengal architectural relief, linking domestic objects, urban workshops and façades. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Terracotta continuity?

A. The source spine runs from Neolithic hand-made coarse ware through Chalcolithic painted wares, Harappan Red Ware and Painted Grey Ware to Northern Black Polished Ware. B. Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern interpretive labels for Harappan objects, not identities read from the undeciphered script. C. NBPW is fine lustrous tableware associated especially with early historic urbanisation; it is not exclusively a Mauryan court product and is not the same as Black-and-Red Ware. D. Terracotta moves from Harappan figurines and plough models to Chandraketugarh craft, Gupta plaques and Bengal architectural relief, linking domestic objects, urban workshops and façades.

Answer: D. Explanation: Terracotta moves from Harappan figurines and plough models to Chandraketugarh craft, Gupta plaques and Bengal architectural relief, linking domestic objects, urban workshops and façades. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Verified sculpture PYQ routes?

A. The routed direct Mains cluster comprises 2019 Gandhara external elements and the 2022 demands on medieval temple sculpture as social evidence and lion-bull significance. B. Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern interpretive labels for Harappan objects, not identities read from the undeciphered script. C. In lost-wax casting a wax model is clay-coated, heated so the wax drains away, and filled with molten metal; the technique is evidenced from the Indus tradition and later enabled free-standing bronzes. D. Read sculpture through material, posture or gesture, iconographic attribute, patron, site context and cross-site comparison; this converts visual description into bounded historical analysis.

Answer: A. Explanation: The routed direct Mains cluster comprises 2019 Gandhara external elements and the 2022 demands on medieval temple sculpture as social evidence and lion-bull significance. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Verified sculpture PYQ routes?”, every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the cultural demand in “Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Verified sculpture PYQ routes?”.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Verified sculpture PYQ routes?
Analysis: Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** A. The routed direct Mains cluster comprises 2019 Gandhara external elements and the 2022 demands on medieval temple sculpture as social evidence and lion-bull significance. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** B. Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern interpretive labels for Harappan objects, not identities read from the undeciphered script. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** C. In lost-wax casting a wax model is clay-coated, heated so the wax drains away, and filled with molten metal; the technique is evidenced from the Indus tradition and later enabled free-standing bronzes. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the cultural demand in “Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Verified sculpture PYQ routes?”.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise five named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For “Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Verified sculpture PYQ routes?”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified sculpture PYQ routes?

A. Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern interpretive labels for Harappan objects, not identities read from the undeciphered script. B. The routed direct Mains cluster comprises 2019 Gandhara external elements and the 2022 demands on medieval temple sculpture as social evidence and lion-bull significance. C. The source spine runs from Neolithic hand-made coarse ware through Chalcolithic painted wares, Harappan Red Ware and Painted Grey Ware to Northern Black Polished Ware. D. In lost-wax casting a wax model is clay-coated, heated so the wax drains away, and filled with molten metal; the technique is evidenced from the Indus tradition and later enabled free-standing bronzes.

Answer: B. Explanation: The routed direct Mains cluster comprises 2019 Gandhara external elements and the 2022 demands on medieval temple sculpture as social evidence and lion-bull significance. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified sculpture PYQ routes?”, every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the cultural demand in “Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified sculpture PYQ routes?”.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified sculpture PYQ routes?
Analysis: Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** A. Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern interpretive labels for Harappan objects, not identities read from the undeciphered script. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** B. The routed direct Mains cluster comprises 2019 Gandhara external elements and the 2022 demands on medieval temple sculpture as social evidence and lion-bull significance. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** C. The source spine runs from Neolithic hand-made coarse ware through Chalcolithic painted wares, Harappan Red Ware and Painted Grey Ware to Northern Black Polished Ware. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the cultural demand in “Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified sculpture PYQ routes?”.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise five named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For “Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified sculpture PYQ routes?”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified sculpture PYQ routes?

A. Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern interpretive labels for Harappan objects, not identities read from the undeciphered script. B. NBPW is fine lustrous tableware associated especially with early historic urbanisation; it is not exclusively a Mauryan court product and is not the same as Black-and-Red Ware. C. The routed direct Mains cluster comprises 2019 Gandhara external elements and the 2022 demands on medieval temple sculpture as social evidence and lion-bull significance. D. The source spine runs from Neolithic hand-made coarse ware through Chalcolithic painted wares, Harappan Red Ware and Painted Grey Ware to Northern Black Polished Ware.

Answer: C. Explanation: The routed direct Mains cluster comprises 2019 Gandhara external elements and the 2022 demands on medieval temple sculpture as social evidence and lion-bull significance. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Demand decoding: Treat “Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified sculpture PYQ routes?” as a form, chronology, region, patron, medium and status problem. Verify every pairing independently without inventing an official key.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the cultural demand in “Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified sculpture PYQ routes?”.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified sculpture PYQ routes? **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A. Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern interpretive labels for Harappan objects, not identities read from the undeciphered script. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** B. NBPW is fine lustrous tableware associated especially with early historic urbanisation; it is not exclusively a Mauryan court product and is not the same as Black-and-Red Ware. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** C. The routed direct Mains cluster comprises 2019 Gandhara external elements and the 2022 demands on medieval temple sculpture as social evidence and lion-bull significance. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the cultural demand in “Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified sculpture PYQ routes?”.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: Fix the category and period; pair form with region, material, patron or institution; separate historical fact from later label or current recognition; eliminate the closest distractor.

Why this earns marks: It preserves answer-text integrity and exact category mapping while keeping reasoned elimination separate from an official key.

How to improve this answer: For “Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified sculpture PYQ routes?”, state why the nearest distractor fails on medium, region, chronology, patronage, terminology or recognition status.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified sculpture PYQ routes?

A. NBPW is fine lustrous tableware associated especially with early historic urbanisation; it is not exclusively a Mauryan court product and is not the same as Black-and-Red Ware. B. Yaksha and Yakshi figures connect water, fertility, trees and wilderness with multiple religions; the Shalabhanjika is a tree-holding yakshi used as an auspicious bracket figure. C. The source spine runs from Neolithic hand-made coarse ware through Chalcolithic painted wares, Harappan Red Ware and Painted Grey Ware to Northern Black Polished Ware. D. The routed direct Mains cluster comprises 2019 Gandhara external elements and the 2022 demands on medieval temple sculpture as social evidence and lion-bull significance.

Answer: D. Explanation: The routed direct Mains cluster comprises 2019 Gandhara external elements and the 2022 demands on medieval temple sculpture as social evidence and lion-bull significance. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Demand decoding: Treat “Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified sculpture PYQ routes?” as a form, chronology, region, patron, medium and status problem. Verify every pairing independently without inventing an official key.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the cultural demand in “Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified sculpture PYQ routes?”.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified sculpture PYQ routes? **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** A. NBPW is fine lustrous tableware associated especially with early historic urbanisation; it is not exclusively a Mauryan court product and is not the same as Black-and-Red Ware. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** B. Yaksha and Yakshi figures connect water, fertility, trees and wilderness with multiple religions; the Shalabhanjika is a tree-holding yakshi used as an auspicious bracket figure. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** C. The source spine runs from Neolithic hand-made coarse ware through Chalcolithic painted wares, Harappan Red Ware and Painted Grey Ware to Northern Black Polished Ware. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the cultural demand in “Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified sculpture PYQ routes?”.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: Fix the category and period; pair form with region, material, patron or institution; separate historical fact from later label or current recognition; eliminate the closest distractor.

Why this earns marks: It preserves answer-text integrity and exact category mapping while keeping reasoned elimination separate from an official key.

How to improve this answer: For “Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified sculpture PYQ routes?”, state why the nearest distractor fails on medium, region, chronology, patronage, terminology or recognition status.

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

Three direct GS-I Mains demands are verified in the 2018-2023 routing ledger: 2019 Gandhara external elements, 2022 medieval temple sculpture as social evidence, and 2022 lion-bull significance. The 2026 empty-seat objective route has only a provisional key and is retained unsolved.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

7. Exact PYQ application

FACT: 2025 Q3 (Chandella sculpture), supported by this topic: while Topic 03 owns the direct answer, this topic supplies the **iconographic reading method** - reading posture, gesture, material and comparative motif (as applied to Nataraja above) - that a strong answer on "resilient vigour and breadth of life" in Chandella sculpture should also apply to Khajuraho's figural corpus. **ANALYSIS:** No Mains question in the audited 2024-2025 papers tests sculpture/pottery/iconography as a stand-alone topic.

2026 PYQ Integration

Status: 2026 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2026.md. **Answer-key rule:** The 2026 Prelims and CSAT Set-A keys held locally are **provisional**; no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Year represented:** 2026
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2026	Prelims GS-I	12	Empty seat symbolism in early Buddhist visual and sacred iconography	Objective question; provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally, answer not inferred	Provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally (Ans-2026-GS1-Provisional); key is provisional - no answer letter recorded or inferred here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Empty seat symbolism in early Buddhist visual and sacred iconography

This block integrates the 2026 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 blocks and does not convert a provisionally-keyed, answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

8. Exact PYQ application

FACT: 2025 Q3 (Chandella sculpture), advanced support: apply the six-factor method (Section 4) to structure a topic-03 answer with explicit evidentiary categories rather than adjective-heavy description. **ANALYSIS:** No Mains question in the audited 2024-2025 papers tests sculpture/ pottery/iconography as a stand-alone topic; this file's contribution is entirely in strengthening topic 03's and topic 09's answers.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2019, 2022
- **Paper(s):** GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 3

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2019	GS-I	1	Central Asian and Greco-Bactrian elements in Gandhara art	Highlight · 10 marks · 150 words	Cross-cutting; art form and Kushana contact both linked	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2022	GS-I	1	Medieval Indian temple sculptures as evidence of social life	How will you explain · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2022	GS-I	13	Lion and bull figures in Indian mythology art and architecture	Discuss the significance · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Central Asian and Greco-Bactrian elements in Gandhara art
- Medieval Indian temple sculptures as evidence of social life
- Lion and bull figures in Indian mythology art and architecture

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2019 GS-I

Demand: Highlight the Central Asian and Greco-Bactrian elements in Gandhara art. (Answer in 150 words)

Status: Verified routed direct Mains demand.

Model solution: Separate Greco-Bactrian body modelling, wavy hair, pleated drapery and workshop material from Central Asian Kushana patronage and layered Parthian-Bactrian transmission; retain the Buddhist subject and add one Mathura contrast.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2019 GS-I”, every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Separate Greco-Bactrian body modelling, wavy hair, pleated drapery and workshop material from Central Asian Kushana patronage and layered Parthian-Bactrian transmission; retain the Buddhist subject and add one Mathura contrast.

Qualification: Bound the claim by period, region, medium, patronage and evidence status; do not convert similarity into direct descent or a commissioned representation into a social census.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise five named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For “PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2019 GS-I”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2022 GS-I

Demand: Medieval Indian temple sculptures represent the social life of those days. How will you explain this statement? (Answer in 150 words)

Status: Verified routed direct Mains demand.

Model solution: Use dancers, musicians, teachers, couples and ritual scenes as patron-selected registers; apply material, posture and site context; qualify that commissioned temple images are not demographic photographs.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2022 GS-I”, every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Use dancers, musicians, teachers, couples and ritual scenes as patron-selected registers; apply material, posture and site context; qualify that commissioned temple images are not demographic photographs.

Qualification: Bound the claim by period, region, medium, patronage and evidence status; do not convert similarity into direct descent or a commissioned representation into a social census.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise five named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For “PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2022 GS-I”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2022 GS-I

Demand: Discuss the significance of the lion and bull figures in Indian mythology, art and architecture. (Answer in 250 words)

Status: Verified routed direct Mains demand.

Model solution: Keep mythology, art and architecture as separate legs; use Harappan bull caution, Rampurva and Sarnath, Nandi mandapas and Yali-Vyala programmes; close with the national-emblem continuity without inventing meanings.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2022 GS-I”, every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Keep mythology, art and architecture as separate legs; use Harappan bull caution, Rampurva and Sarnath, Nandi mandapas and Yali-Vyala programmes; close with the national-emblem continuity without inventing meanings.

Qualification: Bound the claim by period, region, medium, patronage and evidence status; do not convert similarity into direct descent or a commissioned representation into a social census.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise five named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For “PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2022 GS-I”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Highlight the Central Asian and Greco-Bactrian elements in Gandhara art. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Gandhara was a Buddhist iconographic programme rendered in a Hellenised surface idiom under Kushana patronage; named external elements must be separated from the Indian subject.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Gandhara sculpture used bluish-grey sandstone and later stucco for a mainly Buddhist programme whose drapery, hair and body modelling show Hellenistic, Parthian and Central Asian layers.
- Mathura developed in spotted red sandstone, served Buddhist, Hindu and Jain patrons, and used attributes or avayudhas and emphatic halos within an indigenous visual grammar.
- Anthropomorphic Buddha images emerged in broadly overlapping early-CE contexts at Gandhara and Mathura, so neither school should be declared the uncontested sole origin.

Qualified conclusion: Gandhara was a Buddhist iconographic programme rendered in a Hellenised surface idiom under Kushana patronage; named external elements must be separated from the Indian subject.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Highlight the Central Asian and Greco-Bactrian elements in Gandhara art. Answer in about 150...”, every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Gandhara was a Buddhist iconographic programme rendered in a Hellenised surface idiom under Kushana patronage; named external elements must be separated from the Indian subject.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Gandhara sculpture used bluish-grey sandstone and later stucco for a mainly Buddhist programme whose drapery, hair and body modelling show Hellenistic, Parthian and Central Asian layers. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Mathura developed in spotted red sandstone, served Buddhist, Hindu and Jain patrons, and used attributes or avayudhas and emphatic halos within an indigenous visual grammar. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Anthropomorphic Buddha images emerged in broadly overlapping early-CE contexts at Gandhara and Mathura, so neither school should be declared the uncontested sole origin. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

Qualified conclusion: Gandhara was a Buddhist iconographic programme rendered in a Hellenised surface idiom under Kushana patronage; named external elements must be separated from the Indian subject.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise three named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For “Highlight the Central Asian and Greco-Bactrian elements in Gandhara art. Answer in about 150...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: How can medieval temple sculpture be used as evidence of social life? Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Temple sculpture records patron-selected social and ritual visibility through named registers, but cannot be treated as a representative census of ordinary life.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Read sculpture through material, posture or gesture, iconographic attribute, patron, site context and cross-site comparison; this converts visual description into bounded historical analysis.
- Dancers, musicians, teachers, couples and ritual scenes show what patrons selected for visibility; carvings are commissioned representations, not statistical photographs of medieval society.

Qualified conclusion: Temple sculpture records patron-selected social and ritual visibility through named registers, but cannot be treated as a representative census of ordinary life.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “How can medieval temple sculpture be used as evidence of social life? Answer in about 150...”, every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Temple sculpture records patron-selected social and ritual visibility through named registers, but cannot be treated as a representative census of ordinary life.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Read sculpture through material, posture or gesture, iconographic attribute, patron, site context and cross-site comparison; this converts visual description into bounded historical analysis. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Dancers, musicians, teachers, couples and ritual scenes show what patrons selected for visibility; carvings are commissioned representations, not statistical photographs of medieval society. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

Qualified conclusion: Temple sculpture records patron-selected social and ritual visibility through named registers, but cannot be treated as a representative census of ordinary life.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise three named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For “How can medieval temple sculpture be used as evidence of social life? Answer in about 150...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Compare the Gandhara, Mathura and Amaravati schools on common axes. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Material, religious scope, external influence, posture, narrative treatment and patronage reveal three different workshop solutions rather than a quality hierarchy.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Gandhara sculpture used bluish-grey sandstone and later stucco for a mainly Buddhist programme whose drapery, hair and body modelling show Hellenistic, Parthian and Central Asian layers.

- Mathura developed in spotted red sandstone, served Buddhist, Hindu and Jain patrons, and used attributes or avayudhas and emphatic halos within an indigenous visual grammar.
- Amaravati or Vengi sculpture used dynamic narrative relief, greenish-white limestone and extensive tribhanga within a mainly Buddhist Satavahana and later Ikshvaku setting.
- Anthropomorphic Buddha images emerged in broadly overlapping early-CE contexts at Gandhara and Mathura, so neither school should be declared the uncontested sole origin.

Qualified conclusion: Material, religious scope, external influence, posture, narrative treatment and patronage reveal three different workshop solutions rather than a quality hierarchy.

Demand decoding: The directive **compare** requires a direct position on “Compare the Gandhara, Mathura and Amaravati schools on common axes. Answer in about 250 words.”, every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Material, religious scope, external influence, posture, narrative treatment and patronage reveal three different workshop solutions rather than a quality hierarchy.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Gandhara sculpture used bluish-grey sandstone and later stucco for a mainly Buddhist programme whose drapery, hair and body modelling show Hellenistic, Parthian and Central Asian layers. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Mathura developed in spotted red sandstone, served Buddhist, Hindu and Jain patrons, and used attributes or avayudhas and emphatic halos within an indigenous visual grammar. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Amaravati or Vengi sculpture used dynamic narrative relief, greenish-white limestone and extensive tribhanga within a mainly Buddhist Satavahana and later Ikshvaku setting. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Anthropomorphic Buddha images emerged in broadly overlapping early-CE contexts at Gandhara and Mathura, so neither school should be declared the uncontested sole origin. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

Qualified conclusion: Material, religious scope, external influence, posture, narrative treatment and patronage reveal three different workshop solutions rather than a quality hierarchy.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise five named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For “Compare the Gandhara, Mathura and Amaravati schools on common axes. Answer in about 250 words.”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Explain the development and iconographic structure of Nataraja. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Nataraja must be traced from an early Chalukya antecedent to the Chola canonical bronze and decoded attribute by attribute through casting, gesture and ritual mobility.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- In lost-wax casting a wax model is clay-coated, heated so the wax drains away, and filled with molten metal; the technique is evidenced from the Indus tradition and later enabled free-standing bronzes.
- The earliest known Nataraja example in the owner is at Ravana Phadi, Aihole, under early Chalukya rule; Chola bronzes perfected and ritualised the form rather than originating it.
- Damaru signifies creation, fire destruction, abhaya reassurance, the raised foot release, Apasmara ignorance and the surrounding aureole cyclical time; each attribute must be read in position.

Qualified conclusion: Nataraja must be traced from an early Chalukya antecedent to the Chola canonical bronze and decoded attribute by attribute through casting, gesture and ritual mobility.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on “Explain the development and iconographic structure of Nataraja. Answer in about 250 words.”, every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Nataraja must be traced from an early Chalukya antecedent to the Chola canonical bronze and decoded attribute by attribute through casting, gesture and ritual mobility.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** In lost-wax casting a wax model is clay-coated, heated so the wax drains away, and filled with molten metal; the technique is evidenced from the Indus tradition and later enabled free-standing bronzes. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The earliest known Nataraja example in the owner is at Ravana Phadi, Aihole, under early Chalukya rule; Chola bronzes perfected and ritualised the form rather than originating it. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Damaru signifies creation, fire destruction, abhaya reassurance, the raised foot release, Apasmara ignorance and the surrounding aureole cyclical time; each attribute must be read in position. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

Qualified conclusion: Nataraja must be traced from an early Chalukya antecedent to the Chola canonical bronze and decoded attribute by attribute through casting, gesture and ritual mobility.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise five named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For “Explain the development and iconographic structure of Nataraja. Answer in about 250 words.”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Discuss the significance of lion and bull figures in Indian mythology, art and architecture. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: The lion repeatedly visualised authority and doctrine while the bull marked generative, biographical and Shaiva-vahana meanings; Harappan, Buddhist and temple evidence must remain source-separated.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern interpretive labels for Harappan objects, not identities read from the undeciphered script.
- Early Buddhist programmes marked the Buddha through symbols such as the empty throne, Bodhi tree, wheel, footprints and stupa; an empty seat is a presence-marker, not a missing figure.
- Rampurva preserves an inscribed Ashokan lion pillar and an uninscribed bull pillar, while the Sarnath abacus places lion and bull within a wider Buddhist and imperial symbol system.
- At Shaiva temples the bull is not merely ornament: a Nandi mandapa or pavilion stands axially before the sanctum, as at Brihadishvara, Ellora Kailasa and Ramappa.
- Yali is a composite lion-based guardian associated especially with Vijayanagara pillars and Nayaka identity, while Khajuraho Vyalas are hybrid imaginary animals with lions' bodies.

Qualified conclusion: The lion repeatedly visualised authority and doctrine while the bull marked generative, biographical and Shaiva-vahana meanings; Harappan, Buddhist and temple evidence must remain source-separated.

Demand decoding: The directive **discuss** requires a direct position on "Discuss the significance of lion and bull figures in Indian mythology, art and architecture....", every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The lion repeatedly visualised authority and doctrine while the bull marked generative, biographical and Shaiva-vahana meanings; Harappan, Buddhist and temple evidence must remain source-separated.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern interpretive labels for Harappan objects, not identities read from the undeciphered script. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Early Buddhist programmes marked the Buddha through symbols such as the empty throne, Bodhi tree, wheel, footprints and stupa; an empty seat is a presence-marker, not a missing figure. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Rampurva preserves an inscribed Ashokan lion pillar and an uninscribed bull pillar, while the Sarnath abacus places lion and bull within a wider Buddhist and imperial symbol system. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** At Shaiva temples the bull is not merely ornament: a Nandi mandapa or pavilion stands axially before the sanctum, as at Brihadishvara, Ellora Kailasa and Ramappa. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Yali is a composite lion-based guardian associated especially with Vijayanagara pillars and Nayaka identity, while Khajuraho Vyalas are hybrid imaginary animals with lions' bodies. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

Qualified conclusion: The lion repeatedly visualised authority and doctrine while the bull marked generative, biographical and Shaiva-vahana meanings; Harappan, Buddhist and temple evidence must remain source-separated.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise six to eight named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For “Discuss the significance of lion and bull figures in Indian mythology, art and architecture....”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Trace the relationship between material, technique and meaning in Indian sculpture and pottery. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Clay, stone, stucco and bronze enabled different scales, movements and survival patterns; technique shaped representation while chronology and attribution limits prevent a simple progress story.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- In lost-wax casting a wax model is clay-coated, heated so the wax drains away, and filled with molten metal; the technique is evidenced from the Indus tradition and later enabled free-standing bronzes.
- The source spine runs from Neolithic hand-made coarse ware through Chalcolithic painted wares, Harappan Red Ware and Painted Grey Ware to Northern Black Polished Ware.
- NBPW is fine lustrous tableware associated especially with early historic urbanisation; it is not exclusively a Mauryan court product and is not the same as Black-and-Red Ware.
- Yaksha and Yakshi figures connect water, fertility, trees and wilderness with multiple religions; the Shalabhanjika is a tree-holding yakshi used as an auspicious bracket figure.
- The Sarnath school used cream-coloured sandstone and metal for subtly modelled, thinly draped figures; the Sultanganj copper Buddha is safer described as late or post-Gupta.
- Terracotta moves from Harappan figurines and plough models to Chandraketugarh craft, Gupta plaques and Bengal architectural relief, linking domestic objects, urban workshops and façades.

Qualified conclusion: Clay, stone, stucco and bronze enabled different scales, movements and survival patterns; technique shaped representation while chronology and attribution limits prevent a simple progress story.

Demand decoding: The directive **trace** requires a direct position on “Trace the relationship between material, technique and meaning in Indian sculpture and...”, every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Clay, stone, stucco and bronze enabled different scales, movements and survival patterns; technique shaped representation while chronology and attribution limits prevent a simple progress story.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** In lost-wax casting a wax model is clay-coated, heated so the wax drains away, and filled with molten metal; the technique is evidenced from the Indus tradition and later enabled free-standing bronzes. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The source spine runs from Neolithic hand-made coarse ware through Chalcolithic painted wares, Harappan Red Ware and Painted Grey Ware to Northern Black Polished Ware. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** NBPW is fine lustrous tableware associated especially with early historic urbanisation; it is not exclusively a Mauryan court product and is not the same as Black-and-Red Ware. **Analysis:**

Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** Yaksha and Yakshi figures connect water, fertility, trees and wilderness with multiple religions; the Shalabhanjika is a tree-holding yakshi used as an auspicious bracket figure. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** The Sarnath school used cream-coloured sandstone and metal for subtly modelled, thinly draped figures; the Sultanganj copper Buddha is safer described as late or post-Gupta. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** Terracotta moves from Harappan figurines and plough models to Chandraketugarh craft, Gupta plaques and Bengal architectural relief, linking domestic objects, urban workshops and façades. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

Qualified conclusion: Clay, stone, stucco and bronze enabled different scales, movements and survival patterns; technique shaped representation while chronology and attribution limits prevent a simple progress story.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise six to eight named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For “Trace the relationship between material, technique and meaning in Indian sculpture and...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.